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Radio frequency switch control circuitry

Abstract

Apparatus and methods for radio frequency (RF) switch control are provided. In certain embodiments, a level shifter for an RF switch includes a first level-shifting n-type transistor, a first cascode n-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting n-type transistor between a negative charge pump voltage and a first output that provides a first switch control signal, a first level-shifting p-type transistor, a first cascode p-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting p-type transistor between a positive charge pump voltage and the first output, and a second cascode p-type transistor between a regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor and controlled by a first switch enable signal.

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Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATIONS (1) This application is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/663,889, filed May 18, 2022 and titled “RADIO FREQUENCY SWITCH CONTROL CIRCUITRY,” which claims the benefit of priority under 35 U.S.C. § 119 of U.S. Provisional Patent Application No. 63/202,867, filed Jun. 28, 2021 and titled “RADIO FREQUENCY SWITCH CONTROL CIRCUITRY,” which is herein incorporated by reference in its entirety.

BACKGROUND

Field

(1) Embodiments of the invention relate to electronic systems, and in particular, to radio frequency (RF) communication systems.

Description of the Related Technology

(2) Radio frequency (RF) communication systems can be used for transmitting and/or receiving signals of a wide range of frequencies. For example, an RF communication system can be used to wirelessly communicate RF signals in a frequency range of about 30 kHz to 300 GHz, such as in the range of about 400 MHz to about 7.125 GHz for Frequency Range 1 (FR1) of the Fifth Generation (5G) communication standard or in the range of about 24.250 GHz to about 71.000 GHz for Frequency Range 2 (FR2) of the 5G communication standard.

(3) Examples of RF communication systems include, but are not limited to, mobile phones, tablets, base stations, network access points, customer-premises equipment (CPE), laptops, and wearable electronics.

SUMMARY

(4) In certain embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a mobile device. The mobile device includes a power management system including a positive charge pump configured to generate a positive charge pump voltage, a negative charge pump configured to generate a negative charge pump voltage, and a voltage regulator configured to generate a regulated voltage. The mobile device further includes a front end system including a radio frequency switch controlled by a first switch control signal, and a level shifter operable to level shift a first switch enable signal to generate the first switch control signal at a first output. The level shifter includes a first level-shifting n-type transistor and a first cascode n-type transistor in series between the negative charge pump voltage and the first output, a first level-shifting p-type transistor and a first cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the first output, and a second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor and controlled by the first switch enable signal.

(5) In some embodiments, the level shifter is further operable to level shift a second switch enable signal to generate a second switch control signal at a second output, the second switch enable signal of complementary polarity to the first switch enable signal. According to a number of embodiments, the level shifter further includes a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage, a third cascode p-type transistor, and a third level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage. In accordance with various embodiments, the level shifter further includes a fourth level shifting n-type transistor and a second cascode n-type transistor in series between the second output and the negative charge pump voltage, and a second level shifting p-type transistor and a fourth cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the second

output.

(6) In several embodiments, the front end system further includes a power amplifier configured to provide a radio frequency signal to the radio frequency switch.

(7) In some embodiments, the power management system further includes a charge pump clock generator including a multi-phase oscillator configured to generate a plurality of oscillator clock signals, and a clock phase logic and combining circuit configured to process the plurality of oscillator clock signals to generate a first clock signal of higher frequency than an oscillation frequency of the multi-phase oscillator, the first clock signal operable to control at least one of the positive charge pump or the negative charge pump. According to a number of embodiments, the clock phase logic and combining circuit is further configured to generate a second clock signal offset in phase from the first clock signal, the first clock signal operable to control the positive charge pump and the second clock signal operable to control the negative charge pump.

(8) In certain embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a radio frequency switch system. The radio frequency switch system includes a radio frequency switch configured to receive a radio frequency signal and controlled by a first switch control signal, a positive charge pump configured to generate a positive charge pump voltage, a negative charge pump configured to generate a negative charge pump voltage, a voltage regulator configured to generate a regulated voltage, and a level shifter operable to level shift a first switch enable signal to generate the first switch control signal at a first output. The level shifter includes a first level-shifting n-type transistor and a first cascode n-type transistor in series between the negative charge pump voltage and the first output, a first level-shifting p-type transistor and a first cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the first output, and a second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor and controlled by the first switch enable signal.

(9) In some embodiments, the level shifter is further operable to level shift a second switch enable signal to generate a second switch control signal at a second output, the second switch enable signal of complementary polarity to the first switch enable signal. According to a number of embodiments, the level shifter further includes a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage, a third cascode p-type transistor, and a third level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage. In accordance with several embodiments, the level shifter further includes a fourth level shifting n-type transistor and a second cascode n-type transistor in series between the negative charge pump voltage and the second output, and a second level shifting p-type transistor and a fourth cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the second output. According to various embodiments, the radio frequency switch system further includes a first enable level shifting circuit configured to level shift the first switch enable signal to generate a first level shifted switch enable signal that controls a gate of the second level shifting p-type transistor, and a second enable level shifting circuit configured to level shift the second switch enable signal to generate a second level shifted switch enable signal that controls a gate of the first level shifting p-type transistor. In accordance with a number of embodiments, a gate of the first cascode p-type transistor and a gate of the fourth cascode p-type transistor are connected to a ground voltage. According to several embodiments, a gate of the second level shifting n-type transistor and a gate of the fourth level shifting n-type transistor are connected to a drain of the third level shifting n-type transistor, and the gate of the first level shifting n-type transistor and a gate of the third level shifting n-type transistor are connected to a drain of the second level shifting n-type transistor. In accordance with various embodiments, the radio frequency switch includes a series transistor switch electrically connected between an input terminal and an output terminal and controlled by the first switch control signal, and a shunt transistor switch electrically connected between the input terminal and a ground voltage and controlled by the second switch control signal.

- (10) In several embodiments, the radio frequency switch system further includes a charge pump clock generator including a multi-phase oscillator configured to generate a plurality of oscillator clock signals, and a clock phase logic and combining circuit configured to process the plurality of oscillator clock signals to generate a first clock signal of higher frequency than an oscillation frequency of the multi-phase oscillator, the first clock signal operable to control at least one of the positive charge pump or the negative charge pump. According to a number of embodiments, the clock phase logic and combining circuit is further configured to generate a second clock signal offset in phase from the first clock signal, the first clock signal operable to control the positive charge pump and the second clock signal operable to control the negative charge pump.
- (11) In various embodiments, the voltage regulator is a low dropout regulator.
- (12) In certain embodiments, the present disclosure relates to a level shifter for a radio frequency switch. The level shifter includes a first level-shifting n-type transistor, a first cascode n-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting n-type transistor between a negative charge pump voltage and a first output that provides a first switch control signal, a first level-shifting p-type transistor, a first cascode p-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting p-type transistor between a positive charge pump voltage and the first output, and a second cascode p-type transistor between a regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor and controlled by a first switch enable signal.
- (13) In several embodiments, the level shifter further includes a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage, a third cascode p-type transistor, and a third level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage. According to a number of embodiments, the level shifter further includes a fourth level shifting n-type transistor and a second cascode n-type transistor in series between a second output and the negative charge pump voltage, and a second level shifting p-type transistor and a fourth cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the second output. In accordance with various embodiments, the level shifter further includes a first enable level shifting circuit configured to level shift the first switch enable signal to generate a first level shifted switch enable signal that controls a gate of the second level shifting p-type transistor, and a second enable level shifting circuit configured to level shift a second switch enable signal to generate a second level shifted switch enable signal that controls a gate of the first level shifting p-type transistor. According to several embodiments, a gate of the first cascode p-type transistor and a gate of the fourth cascode p-type transistor are connected to a ground voltage. In accordance with a number of embodiments, a gate of the second level shifting n-type transistor and a gate of the fourth level shifting n-type transistor are connected to a drain of the third level shifting n-type transistor, and the gate of the first level shifting n-type transistor and a gate of the third level shifting n-type transistor are connected to a drain of the second level shifting n-type transistor.
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Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of one example of a communication network.
- (2) FIG. 2A is a schematic diagram of one example of a communication link using carrier aggregation.
- (3) FIG. 2B illustrates various examples of uplink carrier aggregation for the communication link of FIG. 2A.
- (4) FIG. 2C illustrates various examples of downlink carrier aggregation for the communication link of FIG. 2A.
- (5) FIG. 3A is a schematic diagram of one example of a downlink channel using multi-input and

multi-output (MIMO) communications.

(6) FIG. 3B is schematic diagram of one example of an uplink channel using MIMO communications.

(7) FIG. 3C is schematic diagram of another example of an uplink channel using MIMO communications.

(8) FIG. 4 is a schematic block diagram of one embodiment of a power amplifier system.

(9) FIG. 5A is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a level shifter.

(10) FIG. 5B is a graph of one example of waveforms for the level shifter of FIG. 5A.

(11) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a charge pump.

(12) FIG. 7A is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a charge pump clock generator.

(13) FIG. 7B is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of frequency multiplying logic for a charge pump clock generator.

(14) FIG. 7C is a graph of one example of waveforms for positive and negative charge pumps operating at different clock frequencies.

(15) FIG. 8A is a schematic diagram of another embodiment of a charge pump clock generator.

(16) FIG. 8B is a schematic diagram of another embodiment of frequency multiplying logic for a charge pump clock generator.

(17) FIG. 8C is a graph of one example of waveforms for a charge pump clock generator.

(18) FIG. 9 is a schematic block diagram of a radio frequency (RF) switch system according to one embodiment.

(19) FIG. 10A is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a packaged module.

(20) FIG. 10B is a schematic diagram of a cross-section of the packaged module of FIG. 10A taken along the lines 10B-10B.

(21) FIG. 11 is a schematic diagram of an RF switch network according to another embodiment.

(22) FIG. 12 is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a mobile device.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION OF EMBODIMENTS

(23) The following detailed description of certain embodiments presents various descriptions of specific embodiments. However, the innovations described herein can be embodied in a multitude of different ways, for example, as defined and covered by the claims. In this description, reference is made to the drawings where like reference numerals can indicate identical or functionally similar elements. It will be understood that elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. Moreover, it will be understood that certain embodiments can include more elements than illustrated in a drawing and/or a subset of the elements illustrated in a drawing. Further, some embodiments can incorporate any suitable combination of features from two or more drawings.

(24) The International Telecommunication Union (ITU) is a specialized agency of the United Nations (UN) responsible for global issues concerning information and communication technologies, including the shared global use of radio spectrum.

(25) The 3rd Generation Partnership Project (3GPP) is a collaboration between groups of telecommunications standard bodies across the world, such as the Association of Radio Industries and Businesses (ARIB), the Telecommunications Technology Committee (TTC), the China Communications Standards Association (CCSA), the Alliance for Telecommunications Industry Solutions (ATIS), the Telecommunications Technology Association (TTA), the European Telecommunications Standards Institute (ETSI), and the Telecommunications Standards Development Society, India (TSDSI).

(26) Working within the scope of the ITU, 3GPP develops and maintains technical specifications for a variety of mobile communication technologies, including, for example, second generation (2G) technology (for instance, Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) and Enhanced Data Rates for GSM Evolution (EDGE)), third generation (3G) technology (for instance, Universal Mobile Telecommunications System (UMTS) and High Speed Packet Access (HSPA)), and fourth generation (4G) technology (for instance, Long Term Evolution (LTE) and LTE-Advanced).

(27) The technical specifications controlled by 3GPP can be expanded and revised by specification releases, which can span multiple years and specify a breadth of new features and evolutions.

(28) In one example, 3GPP introduced carrier aggregation (CA) for LTE in Release 10. Although initially introduced with two downlink carriers, 3GPP expanded carrier aggregation in Release 14 to include up to five downlink carriers and up to three uplink carriers. Other examples of new features and evolutions provided by 3GPP releases include, but are not limited to, License Assisted Access (LAA), enhanced LAA (eLAA), Narrowband Internet of things (NB-IOT), Vehicle-to-Everything (V2X), and High Power User Equipment (HPUE).

(29) 3GPP introduced Phase 1 of fifth generation (5G) technology in Release 15, and introduced Phase 2 of 5G technology in Release 16. Subsequent 3GPP releases will further evolve and expand 5G technology. 5G technology is also referred to herein as 5G New Radio (NR).

(30) 5G NR supports or plans to support a variety of features, such as communications over millimeter wave spectrum, beamforming capability, high spectral efficiency waveforms, low latency communications, multiple radio numerology, and/or non-orthogonal multiple access (NOMA). Although such RF functionalities offer flexibility to networks and enhance user data rates, supporting such features can pose a number of technical challenges.

(31) The teachings herein are applicable to a wide variety of communication systems, including, but not limited to, communication systems using advanced cellular technologies, such as LTE-Advanced, LTE-Advanced Pro, and/or 5G NR.

(32) FIG. 1 is a schematic diagram of one example of a communication network **10**. The communication network **10** includes a macro cell base station **1**, a small cell base station **3**, and various examples of user equipment (UE), including a first mobile device **2a**, a wireless-connected car **2b**, a laptop **2c**, a stationary wireless device **2d**, a wireless-connected train **2e**, a second mobile device **2f**, and a third mobile device **2g**.

(33) Although specific examples of base stations and user equipment are illustrated in FIG. 1, a communication network can include base stations and user equipment of a wide variety of types and/or numbers.

(34) For instance, in the example shown, the communication network **10** includes the macro cell base station **1** and the small cell base station **3**. The small cell base station **3** can operate with relatively lower power, shorter range, and/or with fewer concurrent users relative to the macro cell base station **1**. The small cell base station **3** can also be referred to as a femtocell, a picocell, or a microcell. Although the communication network **10** is illustrated as including two base stations, the communication network **10** can be implemented to include more or fewer base stations and/or base stations of other types.

(35) Although various examples of user equipment are shown, the teachings herein are applicable to a wide variety of user equipment, including, but not limited to, mobile phones, tablets, laptops, IoT devices, wearable electronics, customer premises equipment (CPE), wireless-connected vehicles, wireless relays, and/or a wide variety of other communication devices. Furthermore, user equipment includes not only currently available communication devices that operate in a cellular network, but also subsequently developed communication devices that will be readily implementable with the inventive systems, processes, methods, and devices as described and claimed herein.

(36) The illustrated communication network **10** of FIG. 1 supports communications using a variety of cellular technologies, including, for example, 4G LTE and 5G NR. In certain implementations, the communication network **10** is further adapted to provide a wireless local area network (WLAN), such as WiFi. Although various examples of communication technologies have been provided, the communication network **10** can be adapted to support a wide variety of communication technologies.

(37) Various communication links of the communication network **10** have been depicted in FIG. 1. The communication links can be duplexed in a wide variety of ways, including, for example, using

frequency-division duplexing (FDD) and/or time-division duplexing (TDD). FDD is a type of radio frequency communications that uses different frequencies for transmitting and receiving signals. FDD can provide a number of advantages, such as high data rates and low latency. In contrast, TDD is a type of radio frequency communications that uses about the same frequency for transmitting and receiving signals, and in which transmit and receive communications are switched in time. TDD can provide a number of advantages, such as efficient use of spectrum and variable allocation of throughput between transmit and receive directions.

(38) In certain implementations, user equipment can communicate with a base station using one or more of 4G LTE, 5G NR, and WiFi technologies. In certain implementations, enhanced license assisted access (eLAA) is used to aggregate one or more licensed frequency carriers (for instance, licensed 4G LTE and/or 5G NR frequencies), with one or more unlicensed carriers (for instance, unlicensed WiFi frequencies).

(39) As shown in FIG. 1, the communication links include not only communication links between UE and base stations, but also UE to UE communications and base station to base station communications. For example, the communication network **10** can be implemented to support self-fronthaul and/or self-backhaul.

(40) The communication links can operate over a wide variety of frequencies. In certain implementations, communications are supported using 5G NR technology over one or more frequency bands that are less than 6 Gigahertz (GHz) and/or over one or more frequency bands that are greater than 6 GHz. For example, the communication links can serve Frequency Range 1 (FR1), Frequency Range 2 (FR2), or a combination thereof.

(41) For example, 5G NR can operate with different specifications across frequency bands for 5G, including with flexible numerology compared with fixed numerology for 4G. FR1 (400 MHz to 7125 MHz) bands operate with numerology subcarrier spacing of 15 kHz, 30 kHz and 60 kHz. Additionally, FR2 includes FR2-1 (24 GHz to 52 GHz) and FR2-2 (52 GHz to 71 GHz) and operates with numerology subcarrier spacing of 60 kHz, 120 kHz and 240 kHz to be able to handle higher phase noise and Doppler effects (for instance, for train applications up to 500 km/h).

(42) In certain implementations, a base station and/or user equipment communicates using beamforming. For example, beamforming can be used to focus signal strength to overcome path losses, such as high loss associated with communicating over high signal frequencies. In certain embodiments, user equipment, such as one or more mobile phones, communicate using beamforming on millimeter wave frequency bands in the range of 30 GHz to 300 GHz and/or upper centimeter wave frequencies in the range of 6 GHz to 30 GHz, or more particularly, 24 GHz to 30 GHz. In one embodiment, one or more of the mobile devices support a HPUE power class specification.

(43) Different users of the communication network **10** can share available network resources, such as available frequency spectrum, in a wide variety of ways.

(44) In one example, frequency division multiple access (FDMA) is used to divide a frequency band into multiple frequency carriers. Additionally, one or more carriers are allocated to a particular user. Examples of FDMA include, but are not limited to, single carrier FDMA (SC-FDMA) and orthogonal FDMA (OFDMA). OFDMA is a multicarrier technology that subdivides the available bandwidth into multiple mutually orthogonal narrowband subcarriers, which can be separately assigned to different users.

(45) Other examples of shared access include, but are not limited to, time division multiple access (TDMA) in which a user is allocated particular time slots for using a frequency resource, code division multiple access (CDMA) in which a frequency resource is shared amongst different users by assigning each user a unique code, space-divisional multiple access (SDMA) in which beamforming is used to provide shared access by spatial division, and non-orthogonal multiple access (NOMA) in which the power domain is used for multiple access. For example, NOMA can be used to serve multiple users at the same frequency, time, and/or code, but with different power

levels.

(46) Enhanced mobile broadband (eMBB) refers to technology for growing system capacity of LTE networks. For example, eMBB can refer to communications with a peak data rate of at least 10 Gbps and a minimum of 100 Mbps for each user. Ultra-reliable low latency communications (uRLLC) refers to technology for communication with very low latency, for instance, less than 2 milliseconds. uRLLC can be used for mission-critical communications such as for autonomous driving and/or remote surgery applications. Massive machine-type communications (mMTC) refers to low cost and low data rate communications associated with wireless connections to everyday objects, such as those associated with Internet of Things (IoT) applications.

(47) The communication network **10** of FIG. **1** can be used to support a wide variety of advanced communication features, including, but not limited to, eMBB, uRLLC, and/or mMTC.

(48) FIG. **2A** is a schematic diagram of one example of a communication link using carrier aggregation. Carrier aggregation can be used to widen bandwidth of the communication link by supporting communications over multiple frequency carriers, thereby increasing user data rates and enhancing network capacity by utilizing fragmented spectrum allocations.

(49) In the illustrated example, the communication link is provided between a base station **21** and a mobile device **22**. As shown in FIG. **2A**, the communications link includes a downlink channel used for RF communications from the base station **21** to the mobile device **22**, and an uplink channel used for RF communications from the mobile device **22** to the base station **21**.

(50) Although FIG. **2A** illustrates carrier aggregation in the context of FDD communications, carrier aggregation can also be used for TDD communications.

(51) In certain implementations, a communication link can provide asymmetrical data rates for a downlink channel and an uplink channel. For example, a communication link can be used to support a relatively high downlink data rate to enable high speed streaming of multimedia content to a mobile device, while providing a relatively slower data rate for uploading data from the mobile device to the cloud.

(52) In the illustrated example, the base station **21** and the mobile device **22** communicate via carrier aggregation, which can be used to selectively increase bandwidth of the communication link. Carrier aggregation includes contiguous aggregation, in which contiguous carriers within the same operating frequency band are aggregated. Carrier aggregation can also be non-contiguous, and can include carriers separated in frequency within a common band or in different bands.

(53) In the example shown in FIG. **2A**, the uplink channel includes three aggregated component carriers f.sub.UL1, f.sub.UL2, and f.sub.UL3. Additionally, the downlink channel includes five aggregated component carriers f.sub.DL1, f.sub.DL2, f.sub.DL3, f.sub.DL4, and f.sub.DL5. Although one example of component carrier aggregation is shown, more or fewer carriers can be aggregated for uplink and/or downlink. Moreover, a number of aggregated carriers can be varied over time to achieve desired uplink and downlink data rates.

(54) For example, a number of aggregated carriers for uplink and/or downlink communications with respect to a particular mobile device can change over time. For example, the number of aggregated carriers can change as the device moves through the communication network and/or as network usage changes over time.

(55) FIG. **2B** illustrates various examples of uplink carrier aggregation for the communication link of FIG. **2A**. FIG. **2B** includes a first carrier aggregation scenario **31**, a second carrier aggregation scenario **32**, and a third carrier aggregation scenario **33**, which schematically depict three types of carrier aggregation.

(56) The carrier aggregation scenarios **31-33** illustrate different spectrum allocations for a first component carrier f.sub.UL1, a second component carrier f.sub.UL2, and a third component carrier f.sub.UL3. Although FIG. **2B** is illustrated in the context of aggregating three component carriers, carrier aggregation can be used to aggregate more or fewer carriers. Moreover, although illustrated in the context of uplink, the aggregation scenarios are also applicable to downlink.

(57) The first carrier aggregation scenario **31** illustrates intra-band contiguous carrier aggregation, in which component carriers that are adjacent in frequency and in a common frequency band are aggregated. For example, the first carrier aggregation scenario **31** depicts aggregation of component carriers f.sub.UL1, f.sub.UL2, and f.sub.UL3 that are contiguous and located within a first frequency band BAND1.

(58) With continuing reference to FIG. 2B, the second carrier aggregation scenario **32** illustrates intra-band non-continuous carrier aggregation, in which two or more components carriers that are non-adjacent in frequency and within a common frequency band are aggregated. For example, the second carrier aggregation scenario **32** depicts aggregation of component carriers f.sub.UL1, f.sub.UL2, and f.sub.UL2 that are non-contiguous, but located within a first frequency band BAND1.

(59) The third carrier aggregation scenario **33** illustrates inter-band non-contiguous carrier aggregation, in which component carriers that are non-adjacent in frequency and in multiple frequency bands are aggregated. For example, the third carrier aggregation scenario **33** depicts aggregation of component carriers f.sub.UL1 and f.sub.UL2 of a first frequency band BAND1 with component carrier f.sub.UL3 of a second frequency band BAND2.

(60) FIG. 2C illustrates various examples of downlink carrier aggregation for the communication link of FIG. 2A. The examples depict various carrier aggregation scenarios **34-38** for different spectrum allocations of a first component carrier f.sub.DL1, a second component carrier f.sub.DL2, a third component carrier f.sub.DL3, a fourth component carrier f.sub.DL4, and a fifth component carrier f.sub.DL5. Although FIG. 2C is illustrated in the context of aggregating five component carriers, carrier aggregation can be used to aggregate more or fewer carriers. Moreover, although illustrated in the context of downlink, the aggregation scenarios are also applicable to uplink.

(61) The first carrier aggregation scenario **34** depicts aggregation of component carriers that are contiguous and located within the same frequency band. Additionally, the second carrier aggregation scenario **35** and the third carrier aggregation scenario **36** illustrates two examples of aggregation that are non-contiguous, but located within the same frequency band. Furthermore, the fourth carrier aggregation scenario **37** and the fifth carrier aggregation scenario **38** illustrates two examples of aggregation in which component carriers that are non-adjacent in frequency and in multiple frequency bands are aggregated. As a number of aggregated component carriers increases, a complexity of possible carrier aggregation scenarios also increases.

(62) With reference to FIGS. 2A-2C, the individual component carriers used in carrier aggregation can be of a variety of frequencies, including, for example, frequency carriers in the same band or in multiple bands. Additionally, carrier aggregation is applicable to implementations in which the individual component carriers are of about the same bandwidth as well as to implementations in which the individual component carriers have different bandwidths.

(63) Certain communication networks allocate a particular user device with a primary component carrier (PCC) or anchor carrier for uplink and a PCC for downlink. Additionally, when the mobile device communicates using a single frequency carrier for uplink or downlink, the user device communicates using the PCC. To enhance bandwidth for uplink communications, the uplink PCC can be aggregated with one or more uplink secondary component carriers (SCCs). Additionally, to enhance bandwidth for downlink communications, the downlink PCC can be aggregated with one or more downlink SCCs.

(64) In certain implementations, a communication network provides a network cell for each component carrier. Additionally, a primary cell can operate using a PCC, while a secondary cell can operate using a SCC. The primary and second cells may have different coverage areas, for instance, due to differences in frequencies of carriers and/or network environment.

(65) License assisted access (LAA) refers to downlink carrier aggregation in which a licensed frequency carrier associated with a mobile operator is aggregated with a frequency carrier in unlicensed spectrum, such as WiFi. LAA employs a downlink PCC in the licensed spectrum that

carries control and signaling information associated with the communication link, while unlicensed spectrum is aggregated for wider downlink bandwidth when available. LAA can operate with dynamic adjustment of secondary carriers to avoid WiFi users and/or to coexist with WiFi users. Enhanced license assisted access (eLAA) refers to an evolution of LAA that aggregates licensed and unlicensed spectrum for both downlink and uplink. Furthermore, NR-U can operate on top of LAA/eLAA over a 5 GHz band (5150 to 5925 MHz) and/or a 6 GHz band (5925 MHz to 7125 MHz).

(66) FIG. 3A is a schematic diagram of one example of a downlink channel using multi-input and multi-output (MIMO) communications. FIG. 3B is schematic diagram of one example of an uplink channel using MIMO communications.

(67) MIMO communications use multiple antennas for simultaneously communicating multiple data streams over common frequency spectrum. In certain implementations, the data streams operate with different reference signals to enhance data reception at the receiver. MIMO communications benefit from higher SNR, improved coding, and/or reduced signal interference due to spatial multiplexing differences of the radio environment.

(68) MIMO order refers to a number of separate data streams sent or received. For instance, MIMO order for downlink communications can be described by a number of transmit antennas of a base station and a number of receive antennas for UE, such as a mobile device. For example, two-by-two (2×2) DL MIMO refers to MIMO downlink communications using two base station antennas and two UE antennas. Additionally, four-by-four (4×4) DL MIMO refers to MIMO downlink communications using four base station antennas and four UE antennas.

(69) In the example shown in FIG. 3A, downlink MIMO communications are provided by transmitting using M antennas **43a**, **43b**, **43c**, . . . **43m** of the base station **41** and receiving using N antennas **44a**, **44b**, **44c**, . . . **44n** of the mobile device **42**. Accordingly, FIG. 3A illustrates an example of $m \times n$ DL MIMO.

(70) Likewise, MIMO order for uplink communications can be described by a number of transmit antennas of UE, such as a mobile device, and a number of receive antennas of a base station. For example, 2×2 UL MIMO refers to MIMO uplink communications using two UE antennas and two base station antennas. Additionally, 4×4 UL MIMO refers to MIMO uplink communications using four UE antennas and four base station antennas.

(71) In the example shown in FIG. 3B, uplink MIMO communications are provided by transmitting using N antennas **44a**, **44b**, **44c**, . . . **44n** of the mobile device **42** and receiving using M antennas **43a**, **43b**, **43c**, . . . **43m** of the base station **41**. Accordingly, FIG. 3B illustrates an example of $n \times m$ UL MIMO.

(72) By increasing the level or order of MIMO, data bandwidth of an uplink channel and/or a downlink channel can be increased.

(73) MIMO communications are applicable to communication links of a variety of types, such as FDD communication links and TDD communication links.

(74) FIG. 3C is schematic diagram of another example of an uplink channel using MIMO communications. In the example shown in FIG. 3C, uplink MIMO communications are provided by transmitting using N antennas **44a**, **44b**, **44c**, . . . **44n** of the mobile device **42**. Additionally a first portion of the uplink transmissions are received using M antennas **43a1**, **43b1**, **43c1**, **43m1** of a first base station **41a**, while a second portion of the uplink transmissions are received using M antennas **43a2**, **43b2**, **43c2**, **43m2** of a second base station **41b**. Additionally, the first base station **41a** and the second base station **41b** communicate with one another over wired, optical, and/or wireless links.

(75) The MIMO scenario of FIG. 3C illustrates an example in which multiple base stations cooperate to facilitate MIMO communications.

(76) FIG. 4 is a schematic block diagram of one embodiment of a power amplifier system **140**. The illustrated power amplifier system **140** includes an RF switching circuit **127** that includes a series

switch transistor **125** and a shunt switch transistor **126**. The illustrated power amplifier system **140** further includes charge pumps **122**, a level shifter **123**, a directional coupler **124**, a power amplifier bias circuit **130**, a power amplifier **132**, and a transmitter **133**. The illustrated transmitter **133** includes a baseband processor **134**, an I/Q modulator **137**, a mixer **138**, and an analog-to-digital converter (ADC) **139**. Although not illustrated in FIG. **4** for clarity, the transmitter **133** can include circuitry associated with receiving signals over one or more receive paths such that transceiver functionality is achieved.

(77) The baseband signal processor **134** can be used to generate an in-phase (I) signal and a quadrature-phase (Q) signal, which can be used to represent a sinusoidal wave or signal of a desired amplitude, frequency, and phase. For example, the I signal can be used to represent an in-phase component of the sinusoidal wave and the Q signal can be used to represent a quadrature component of the sinusoidal wave, which can be an equivalent representation of the sinusoidal wave. In certain implementations, the I and Q signals can be provided to the I/Q modulator **137** in a digital format. The baseband processor **134** can be any suitable processor configured to process a baseband signal. For instance, the baseband processor **134** can include a digital signal processor, a microprocessor, a programmable core, or any combination thereof. Moreover, in some implementations, two or more baseband processors **134** can be included in the power amplifier system **140**.

(78) The I/Q modulator **137** can be configured to receive the I and Q signals from the baseband processor **134** and to process the I and Q signals to generate an RF signal. For example, the I/Q modulator **137** can include DACs configured to convert the I and Q signals into an analog format, mixers for upconverting the I and Q signals to radio frequency, and a signal combiner for combining the upconverted I and Q signals into an RF signal suitable for amplification by the power amplifier **132**. In certain implementations, the I/Q modulator **137** can include one or more filters configured to filter frequency content of signals processed therein.

(79) The power amplifier bias circuit **130** can receive one or more control signals from the baseband processor **134**, which can be used to generate one or more bias signals for the power amplifier **132**. The control signals can include, for example, bias settings or levels and/or enable functionality. The power amplifier **132** can receive the RF signal from the I/Q modulator **137** of the transmitter **133**.

(80) The level shifter **123** can turn on and off the series switch transistor **125** and the shunt switch transistor **126** in a complementary manner. For example, the level shifter **123** can be used to turn on the series switch transistor **125** and turn off the shunt switch transistor **126** such that the power amplifier **132** provides an amplified RF signal to the antenna **114** through the series switch transistor **125**. Additionally, the level shifter **123** can be used to turn off the series switch transistor **125** and turn on the shunt switch transistor **126** to provide a high impedance path between the output of the power amplifier **132** and the antenna **114** while providing termination to the power amplifier's output. To control a state of the RF switching circuit **127**, the level shifter **123** can receive a switch enable signal (not illustrated in FIG. **4**) from any suitable circuitry, such as the transmitter **133**.

(81) The directional coupler **124** can be positioned between the output of the power amplifier **132** and the source of the series switch transistor **125**, thereby allowing an output power measurement of the power amplifier **132** that does not include insertion loss of the series switch transistor **125**. The sensed output signal from the directional coupler **124** can be provided to the mixer **138**, which can multiply the sensed output signal by a reference signal of a controlled frequency so as to downshift the frequency content of the sensed output signal to generate a downshifted signal. The downshifted signal can be provided to the ADC **139**, which can convert the downshifted signal to a digital format suitable for processing by the baseband processor **134**.

(82) By including a feedback path between the output of the power amplifier **132** and the baseband processor **134**, the baseband processor **134** can be configured to dynamically adjust the I and Q

signals to optimize the operation of the power amplifier system **140**. For example, configuring the power amplifier system **140** in this manner can aid in controlling the power added efficiency (PAE) and/or linearity of the power amplifier **132**.

(83) In the illustrated configuration, the charge pumps **122** provide a positive charge pump voltage and a negative charge pump voltage to the level shifter **123**. In certain configurations (for instance, when the switches are implemented using n-type transistors), the positive charge pump voltage is used to bias the gate voltage of the series switch transistor **125** and/or the shunt switch transistor **126** when turned on, while the negative charge pump voltage is used to bias the gate voltage of the series switch transistor **125** and/or the shunt switch transistor **126** when turned off.

(84) Although the series switch transistor **125** and the shunt switch transistor **126** are each depicted as a single transistor, typically a stack of transistors is used to implement each of the series switch transistor **125** and the shunt switch transistor **126**. For example, stacking transistors aids in meeting a desired power handling capability. Furthermore, certain biasing details of the series switch transistor **125** and the shunt switch transistor **126**, such as gate resistors and other biasing, are not depicted in FIG. **4** for clarity of the drawing.

(85) FIG. **5A** is a circuit diagram of one embodiment of a level shifter **210**. The level shifter **210** includes a first n-type metal oxide semiconductor (NMOS) level-shifting transistor **171**, a second NMOS level-shifting transistor **172**, a third NMOS level-shifting transistor **173**, a fourth NMOS level-shifting transistor **174**, a first NMOS cascode transistor **181**, a second NMOS cascode transistor **182**, a first p-type metal oxide semiconductor (PMOS) level-shifting transistor **191**, a second PMOS level-shifting transistor **192**, a first PMOS cascode transistor **193**, a second PMOS cascode transistor **194**, a third PMOS cascode transistor **195**, a fourth PMOS cascode transistor **196**, a first enable level shifter **207**, and a second enable level shifter **208**.

(86) In the illustrated embodiment, the level shifter **210** receives a switch enable signal SW.sub.EN, an inverted switch enable signal SW.sub.ENB, a regulated voltage V.sub.REG (from a voltage regulator, such as a low dropout regulator), a negative charge pump voltage V.sub.NEG (from a negative charge pump), and a positive charge pump voltage V.sub.POS (from a positive charge pump). The level shifter **210** includes a non-inverted switch control output SW.sub.CTL and an inverted switch control output SW.sub.CTLB for generating switch controls signals of complementary polarity for controlling an RF switching circuit (for instance, one for controlling a series switch and another for controlling a shunt switch as in the configuration of FIG. **4**). Although both outputs are used in certain applications, in other implementations only one of the level shifter's outputs is used.

(87) The first enable level shifter **207** level shifts the switch enable signal SW.sub.EN to generate a level-shifted switch enable signal in a voltage domain of the positive charge pump (the first enable level shifter **207** and the second enable level shifter **208** are powered by V.sub.POS and ground). Additionally, the second enable level shifter **208** level shifts the inverted switch enable signal SW.sub.ENB to generate a level-shifted inverted switch enable signal in the voltage domain of the positive charge pump. Although shown as receiving a pair of switch enable signals of complementary polarity, in another embodiment the level shifter **210** receives a single switch enable signal, which can be inverted (for instance, using an inverter) to generate the pair of switch enable signals.

(88) As shown in FIG. **5A**, the first NMOS level-shifting transistor **171** and the first NMOS cascode transistor **181** are in series (from source to drain) between the negative charge pump voltage V.sub.NEG and the inverted switch control output SW.sub.CTLB, while the first PMOS level-shifting transistor **191** and the first PMOS cascode transistor **193** are in series (from source to drain) between the positive charge pump voltage V.sub.POS and the inverted switch control output SW.sub.CTLB. Furthermore, the fourth NMOS level-shifting transistor **174** and the second NMOS cascode transistor **182** are in series (from source to drain) between the negative charge pump voltage V.sub.NEG and the non-inverted switch control output SW.sub.CTL, while the second

PMOS level-shifting transistor **192** and the fourth PMOS cascode transistor **196** are in series (from source to drain) between the positive charge pump voltage $V_{sub.POS}$ and the non-inverted switch control output $SW_{sub.CTL}$.

(89) In the illustrated embodiment, the gate of first NMOS level-shifting transistor **171** and the gate of the third NMOS level-shifting transistor **173** are connected to a drain of the second NMOS level-shifting transistor **172**. Additionally, the gate of second NMOS level-shifting transistor **172** and the gate of the fourth NMOS level-shifting transistor **174** are connected to a drain of the third NMOS level-shifting transistor **173**. The gates and drains of the second NMOS level-shifting transistor **172** and the third NMOS level-shifting transistor **173** are cross-coupled.

(90) The gate of the first NMOS cascode transistor **181** and the gate of the second NMOS cascode transistor **182** are connected to the regulated voltage $V_{sub.REG}$. Additionally, the gate of the second PMOS cascode transistor **194** is controlled by the switch enable signal $SW_{sub.EN}$, while the gate of the third PMOS cascode transistor **195** is controlled by the inverted switch enable signal $SW_{sub.ENB}$.

(91) The gate of first PMOS cascode transistor **193** and the fourth PMOS cascode transistor **196** are grounded. Additionally, the gate of first PMOS level-shifting transistor **191** receives the level-shifted inverted switch enable signal, while the gate of the second PMOS level-shifting transistor **192** receives the level-shifted switch enable signal.

(92) The level shifter **210** provides a number of advantages, including low current draw from the charge pump voltages $V_{sub.POS}$ and $V_{sub.NEG}$, low voltage headroom, and robust latching (of cross-coupled transistors **172** and **173**) during low voltage operation. Moreover, the regulated voltage $V_{sub.REG}$ is low impedance to maintain robust operation, and also is active quickly after start-up. Thus, the level shifter **210** is associated with fast start-up time, and can perform level-shifting even when the charge pump voltages $V_{sub.POS}$ and/or $V_{sub.NEG}$ are not at a steady-state value, such as shortly after power supply sequencing and/or start-up.

(93) FIG. 5B is a graph of one example of waveforms for the level shifter **210** of FIG. 5A. The graph includes waveforms of the positive charge pump voltage $V_{sub.POS}$, the negative charge pump voltage $V_{sub.NEG}$, the switch control output $SW_{sub.CTL}$, and the inverted switch control output $SW_{sub.CTLB}$ for an example in which the positive and negative charge pumps drive many level shifters and suffer from large current draws at certain time instances (at about 12 microseconds (μs) and 27 μs in this simulation) associated with changing the state of the switches, for instance, at end of the transmit or receive time slot in a time-division duplexing (TDD) application.

(94) As shown in FIG. 5B, even in the presence of large current draws on the charge pump supplies, the level shifter **210** continues to properly operate.

(95) FIG. 6 is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a charge pump **220**. The charge pump **220** includes a first group of clock inverters **211a/212a/213a**, a second group of clock inverters **211b/212b/213b**, a first flying capacitor C_{fly1} , a second flying capacitor C_{fly2} , a first NMOS transistor **215**, a second NMOS transistor **216**, a first PMOS transistor **217**, and a second PMOS transistor **218**.

(96) With continuing reference to FIG. 6, the charge pump **220** includes a first clock input CLK for receiving a non-inverted clock signal for driving the first group of clock inverters **211a/212a/213a**, and a second clock input CLK_B for receiving an inverted clock signal for driving the second group of clock inverters **211b/212b/213b**. The first group of clock inverters **211a/212a/213a** are sized to buffer the non-inverted clock signal to provide a drive strength sufficient for driving a first end of the first flying capacitor C_{fly1} . Similarly, the second group of clock inverters **211b/212b/213b** are sized to buffer the inverted clock signal to provide a drive strength sufficient for driving a first end of the second flying capacitor C_{fly2} .

(97) The clock inverter groups can include any suitable number of inverters, and can be scaled ($1\times$, $4\times$, and $12\times$, in this example) in any suitable manner. Thus, although an example with three inverters

with a 4× scaling is shown, more or fewer inverters and/or a different scaling can be used. In certain implementations, the buffered clock signals used to drive the flying capacitors correspond to a pair of non-overlapping clock signals.

(98) As shown in FIG. 6, the charge pump **220** includes a first terminal VP and a second terminal VN. Based on the connectivity of the first terminal VP and the second terminal VN, the charge pump **220** can serve as either a positive charge pump (generating V.sub.POS at the first terminal VP with a boosted voltage relative to the second terminal VN, for instance, connected to a normal supply voltage provided to a pin of the die) or a negative charge pump (generating V.sub.NEG at the second terminal VN with a reduced or buck voltage relative to the first terminal VP, for instance, connected to ground).

(99) FIG. 7A is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a charge pump clock generator **230**. The charge pump clock generator **230** includes a multi-phase oscillator (corresponding to a seven phase ring oscillator **221**, in this example). The charge pump clock generator **230** further includes a clock phase logic circuit **222** (implemented as AND gates **222a**, **222b**, **222c**, **222d**, **222e**, **222f**, and **222g**, in this example) and a clock phase combining circuit **223**.

(100) In the illustrated embodiment, the ring oscillator **221** generates clock signals clk<1>, clk<2>, clk<3>, clk<4>, clk<5>, clk<6>, and clk<7>, which are of common frequency but of different (for instance, evenly separated) phases. Additionally, the AND gates **222a**, **222b**, **222c**, **222d**, **222e**, **222f**, and **222g** perform logical operations on adjacent clock signal phases to generate clock phase signals ph1, ph2, ph3, ph4, ph5, ph6, and ph7, which are processed by the phase combining circuit **223** to generate a clock signal CLK of multiplied frequency relative to the oscillation frequency of the ring oscillator **221**.

(101) In this example, the AND gates each operate with a respective enable signal EN1, EN2, EN3, EN4, EN5, EN6, and EN7 to selectively enable one or more of the clock phase signals ph1, ph2, ph3, ph4, ph5, ph6, and ph7, respectively.

(102) The charge pump clock generator **230** advantageously synthesizes a clock signal of higher frequency than the oscillator **221**. This in turn reduces frequency spurs and/or undesired clock noise in a charge pump output voltage (for instance, V.sub.POS or V.sub.NEG) that is generated by a charge pump that uses the clock signal to control pumping.

(103) FIG. 7B is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of frequency multiplying logic **240** for a charge pump clock generator. The frequency multiplying logic **240** includes a clock phase logic circuit **232** (implemented as AND gates **232a**, **232b**, **232c**, **232d**, **232e**, **232f**, **232g**, **232h**, and **232i**, in this example) and a clock phase combining circuit **233** (implemented as OR gates **233a**, **233b**, **234**, and **235**, in this example).

(104) In the illustrated embodiment, the clock phase logic circuit processes nine clock signals (CLK <1>, CLK <2>, CLK <3>, CLK <4>, CLK <5>, CLK <6>, CLK <7>, CLK <8>, and CLK <9>) from a multi-phase oscillator (for instance, a ring oscillator) to generate clock signal phases CLK_a<1>, CLK_a<2>, CLK_a<3>, CLK_a<4>, CLK_a<5>, CLK_a<6>, CLK_a<7>, CLK_a<8>, and CLK_a<9>. The phase combining circuit **233** performs a logical OR of the clock signal phases to generate a boosted clock signal FCLK_BOOST of higher frequency than that of the received clock signals from the multi-phase oscillator.

(105) FIG. 7C is a graph of one example of waveforms for positive and negative charge pumps operating at different clock frequencies. As shown by the waveforms, faster clock speed is advantageous for providing a charge pump with higher output drive capability and/or initial ramp-up time.

(106) Although fast clock speed is desirable, frequency spurs and/or undesired clock noise is introduced when using a fast oscillator. By synthesizing a faster clock signal for a charge pump using a slower running oscillator in accordance with the teachings herein, the benefits of fast pumping, small frequency spurs, and/or low clock noise are achieved.

(107) FIG. 8A is a schematic diagram of another embodiment of a charge pump clock generator

250. The charge pump clock generator **250** includes a multi-phase oscillator (corresponding to a seven phase ring oscillator **241**, in this example). The charge pump clock generator **230** further includes a clock phase logic and combining circuit **242** (implemented as exclusive OR gates **242a**, **242b**, and **242c**, in this example).

(108) The clock phase logic and combining circuit **242** processes the oscillator clock signals from the multi-phase oscillator to generate a first multiplied clock signal (CLK_DBL<1> or pvg) for driving a positive charge pump (for example, CLK_DBL<1> can be inverted to generate a pair of input clock signals CLK and CLKB to the charge pump **220** of FIG. **6**) and a second multiplied clock signal (CLK_DBL<3> or nvg) for driving a negative charge pump.

(109) Advantageously, the first multiplied clock signal and the second multiplied clock signal are of common frequency, but offset in phase to spread out the time instances of current draw of the positive charge pump and the negative charge pump. Thus, enhanced performance is achieved relative to a configuration in which the clock signals to the positive charge pump and the negative charge pump are of the same phase (phase-aligned).

(110) FIG. **8B** is a schematic diagram of another embodiment of frequency multiplying logic **260** for a charge pump clock generator. In this example, XOR gates **251** and **252** are used to process clock signal phases (CLK<1>, CLK<3>, CLK<5>, and CLK<8>) to synthesize clock signals CLK_DBL1 and CLK_DBL2, respectively, of double frequency (doubling). Additionally, OR gate **253** is used to process the clock signals CLK_DBL1 and CLK_DBL2 to generate a clock signal CLK_4× of four times the frequency (frequency quadrupling) relative to the original clock signal phases (CLK<1>, CLK<3>, CLK<5>, and CLK<8>).

(111) FIG. **8C** is a graph of one example of waveforms for a charge pump clock generator. The waveforms correspond to a charge pump clock generator that including the frequency multiplying logic **260** of FIG. **8B**. As shown in FIG. **8C**, frequency quadrupling is achieved.

(112) FIG. **9** is a schematic block diagram of an RF switch system **290** according to one embodiment. The RF switch system **290** includes RF switches **291a**, **291b**, . . . **291n**, a switch controller **292**, a positive charge pump **293** that generates a positive charge pump voltage V.sub.POS, a negative charge pump **294** that generates a negative charge pump voltage V.sub.NEG, and a charge pump clock generator **295**.

(113) As shown in FIG. **9**, the switch controller **292** includes a voltage regulator (corresponding to a low dropout regulator **297**, in this example) that generates a regulated voltage VREG, and level shifters **298a**, **298b**, . . . **298n**.

(114) The level shifters **298a**, **298b**, . . . **298n** operate to level shift the switch enable signals SW.sub.ENa, SW.sub.ENb, . . . SW.sub.ENn to generate the switch control signals SW.sub.CTLa, SW.sub.CTLb, . . . SW.sub.CTLn for the RF switches **291a**, **291b**, . . . **291n**, respectively. As shown in FIG. **9**, the level shifters **298a**, **298b**, . . . **298n** each receive the regulated voltage V.sub.REG, the positive charge pump voltage V.sub.POS, and the negative charge pump voltage V.sub.NEG. Additionally, the charge pump clock generator **295** generates clock signals for the positive charge pump **293** and the negative charge pump **294**.

(115) The level shifters **298a**, **298b**, . . . **298n** and/or the charge pump clock generator **295** can be implemented in accordance with any of the embodiments herein.

(116) Although the illustrated RF switch system **290** includes three level shifters and three switches, any number of level shifters and switches can be included.

(117) FIG. **10A** is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a packaged module **300**. FIG. **10B** is a schematic diagram of a cross-section of the packaged module **300** of FIG. **10A** taken along the lines **10B-10B**.

(118) The packaged module **300** includes an IC or die **301**, surface mount components **303**, wirebonds **308**, a package substrate **320**, and encapsulation structure **340**. The package substrate **320** includes pads **306** formed from conductors disposed therein. Additionally, the die **301** includes pads **304**, and the wirebonds **308** have been used to electrically connect the pads **304** of the die **301**

to the pads **306** of the package substrate **301**.

(119) As illustrated in FIGS. **10A** and **10B**, the die **301** includes charge pumps **122**, level shifter **123**, and switches **127**, which can be as described earlier.

(120) The packaging substrate **320** can be configured to receive a plurality of components such as the die **301** and the surface mount components **303**, which can include, for example, surface mount capacitors and/or inductors.

(121) As shown in FIG. **10B**, the packaged module **300** is shown to include a plurality of contact pads **332** disposed on the side of the packaged module **300** opposite the side used to mount the die **301**. Configuring the packaged module **300** in this manner can aid in connecting the packaged module **300** to a circuit board such as a phone board of a wireless device. The example contact pads **332** can be configured to provide RF signals, bias signals, power low voltage(s) and/or power high voltage(s) to the die **301** and/or the surface mount components **303**. As shown in FIG. **10B**, the electrical connections between the contact pads **332** and the die **301** can be facilitated by connections **333** through the package substrate **320**. The connections **333** can represent electrical paths formed through the package substrate **320**, such as connections associated with vias and conductors of a multilayer laminated package substrate.

(122) In some embodiments, the packaged module **300** can also include one or more packaging structures to, for example, provide protection and/or facilitate handling of the packaged module **300**. Such a packaging structure can include overmold or encapsulation structure **340** formed over the packaging substrate **320** and the components and die(s) disposed thereon.

(123) It will be understood that although the packaged module **300** is described in the context of electrical connections based on wirebonds, one or more features of the present disclosure can also be implemented in other packaging configurations, including, for example, flip-chip configurations.

(124) FIG. **11** is a schematic diagram of an RF switch network **420** according to another embodiment. The RF switch network **420** includes a first series transistor switch **361**, a second series transistor switch **365**, a first input shunt transistor switch **381**, a second input shunt transistor switch **385**, a first output shunt transistor switch **401**, and a second output shunt transistor switch **405**.

(125) The RF switch network **420** of FIG. **11** illustrates another embodiment of an RF switch network suitable for use in an RF switch system, such as the RF switch system **120** of FIG. **4**. However other implementations are possible, including, but not limited, RF switch networks including more or fewer series transistor switches and/or more or fewer shunt transistor switches.

(126) In the illustrated embodiment, the first series transistor switch **361** is electrically connected between a first RF input terminal RF_IN1 and an RF output terminal RF_OUT, and the second series transistor switch **365** is electrically connected between a second RF input terminal RF_IN2 and the RF output terminal RF_OUT. Additionally, the first input shunt transistor switch **381** is electrically connected between the first RF input terminal RF_IN1 and ground, and the second input shunt transistor **385** is electrically between the second RF input terminal RF_IN2 and ground. Furthermore, the first output shunt transistor switch **401** is electrically connected between the RF output terminal RF_OUT and ground, and the second output shunt transistor switch **405** is electrically connected between the RF output terminal RF_OUT and ground.

(127) As shown in FIG. **11**, a first switch control voltage V.sub.CTL1 controls the first series transistor switch **361**, and a first inverted switch control voltage V.sub.CTL1B controls the first input shunt transistor switch **381** and the first output shunt transistor switch **401**. Furthermore, a second switch control voltage V.sub.CTL2 controls the second series transistor switch **365**, and a second inverted switch control voltage V.sub.CTL2B controls the second input shunt transistor switch **385** and the second output shunt transistor switch **405**. In certain implementations, a first level shifter generates the first switch control voltage V.sub.CTL1 and the first inverted switch control voltage V.sub.CTL1B, while a second level shifter generates the second switch control voltage V.sub.CTL2 and the second inverted switch control voltage V.sub.CTL2B.

(128) The depicted transistor switches each include a number of transistors in series to achieve a desired power handling capability, with the transistors biased used corresponding gate resistors and channel resistors.

(129) For example, the first series transistor switch **361** includes NFETs **371a**, **371b**, . . . **371n**, gate resistors **372a**, **372b**, . . . **372n**, and channel resistors **373a**, **373b**, . . . **373n**. Additionally, the second series transistor switch **365** includes NFETs **375a**, **375b**, . . . **375n**, gate resistors **376a**, **376b**, . . . **376n**, and channel resistors **377a**, **377b**, . . . **377n**. Furthermore, the first input shunt transistor switch **381** includes NFETs **391a**, **391b**, gate resistors **392a**, **392b**, and channel resistors **393a**, **393b**. Additionally, the second input shunt transistor switch **385** includes NFETs **395a**, **395b**, gate resistors **396a**, **396b**, and channel resistors **397a**, **397b**. Furthermore, the first output shunt transistor switch **401** includes NFETs **411a**, **411b**, gate resistors **412a**, **412b**, and channel resistors **413a**, **413b**. Additionally, the second output shunt transistor switch **405** includes NFETs **415a**, **415b**, gate resistors **416a**, **416b**, and channel resistors **417a**, **417b**.

(130) FIG. **12** is a schematic diagram of one embodiment of a mobile device **800**. The mobile device **800** includes a baseband system **801**, a transceiver **802**, a front end system **803**, antennas **804**, a power management system **805**, a memory **806**, a user interface **807**, and a battery **808**.

(131) The mobile device **800** can be used communicate using a wide variety of communications technologies, including, but not limited to, 2G, 3G, 4G (including LTE, LTE-Advanced, and LTE-Advanced Pro), 5G NR, WLAN (for instance, WiFi), WPAN (for instance, Bluetooth and ZigBee), WMAN (for instance, WiMax), and/or GPS technologies.

(132) The transceiver **802** generates RF signals for transmission and processes incoming RF signals received from the antennas **804**. It will be understood that various functionalities associated with the transmission and receiving of RF signals can be achieved by one or more components that are collectively represented in FIG. **12** as the transceiver **802**. In one example, separate components (for instance, separate circuits or dies) can be provided for handling certain types of RF signals.

(133) The front end system **803** aids is conditioning signals transmitted to and/or received from the antennas **804**. In the illustrated embodiment, the front end system **803** includes level shifters **810**, power amplifiers (PAs) **811**, low noise amplifiers (LNAs) **812**, filters **813**, switches **814**, and signal splitting/combining circuitry **815**. However, other implementations are possible.

(134) For example, the front end system **803** can provide a number of functionalities, including, but not limited to, amplifying signals for transmission, amplifying received signals, filtering signals, switching between different bands, switching between different power modes, switching between transmission and receiving modes, duplexing of signals, multiplexing of signals (for instance, duplexing or triplexing), or some combination thereof.

(135) In certain implementations, the mobile device **800** supports carrier aggregation, thereby providing flexibility to increase peak data rates. Carrier aggregation can be used for both Frequency Division Duplexing (FDD) and Time Division Duplexing (TDD), and may be used to aggregate a plurality of carriers or channels. Carrier aggregation includes contiguous aggregation, in which contiguous carriers within the same operating frequency band are aggregated. Carrier aggregation can also be non-contiguous, and can include carriers separated in frequency within a common band or in different bands.

(136) The antennas **804** can include antennas used for a wide variety of types of communications. For example, the antennas **804** can include antennas for transmitting and/or receiving signals associated with a wide variety of frequencies and communications standards.

(137) In certain implementations, the antennas **804** support MIMO communications and/or switched diversity communications. For example, MIMO communications use multiple antennas for communicating multiple data streams over a single radio frequency channel. MIMO communications benefit from higher signal to noise ratio, improved coding, and/or reduced signal interference due to spatial multiplexing differences of the radio environment. Switched diversity refers to communications in which a particular antenna is selected for operation at a particular time.

For example, a switch can be used to select a particular antenna from a group of antennas based on a variety of factors, such as an observed bit error rate and/or a signal strength indicator.

(138) The mobile device **800** can operate with beamforming in certain implementations. For example, the front end system **803** can include amplifiers having controllable gain and phase shifters having controllable phase to provide beam formation and directivity for transmission and/or reception of signals using the antennas **804**. For example, in the context of signal transmission, the amplitude and phases of the transmit signals provided to the antennas **804** are controlled such that radiated signals from the antennas **804** combine using constructive and destructive interference to generate an aggregate transmit signal exhibiting beam-like qualities with more signal strength propagating in a given direction. In the context of signal reception, the amplitude and phases are controlled such that more signal energy is received when the signal is arriving to the antennas **804** from a particular direction. In certain implementations, the antennas **804** include one or more arrays of antenna elements to enhance beamforming.

(139) The baseband system **801** is coupled to the user interface **807** to facilitate processing of various user input and output (I/O), such as voice and data. The baseband system **801** provides the transceiver **802** with digital representations of transmit signals, which the transceiver **802** processes to generate RF signals for transmission. The baseband system **801** also processes digital representations of received signals provided by the transceiver **802**. As shown in FIG. 12, the baseband system **801** is coupled to the memory **806** of facilitate operation of the mobile device **800**.

(140) The memory **806** can be used for a wide variety of purposes, such as storing data and/or instructions to facilitate the operation of the mobile device **800** and/or to provide storage of user information.

(141) The power management system **805** provides a number of power management functions of the mobile device **800**. In certain implementations, the power management system **805** includes a PA supply control circuit that controls the supply voltages of the power amplifiers **811**. For example, the power management system **805** can be configured to change the supply voltage(s) provided to one or more of the power amplifiers **811** to improve efficiency, such as power added efficiency (PAE).

(142) As shown in FIG. 12, the power management system **805** receives a battery voltage from the battery **808**. The battery **808** can be any suitable battery for use in the mobile device **800**, including, for example, a lithium-ion battery.

(143) The mobile device **800** can include any combination of features of the present disclosure. For example, in certain embodiments, the power management system **805** includes a positive charge pump that generates a positive charge pump voltage, a negative charge pump that generates a negative charge pump voltage, and a voltage regulator that generates a regulated voltage. Additionally, the front end system **803** includes an RF switch (of switches **814**) controlled by a level shifter (of level shifters **810**) with the level shifter receiving the positive charge pump voltage, the negative charge pump voltage, and the regulated voltage.

CONCLUSION

(144) Some of the embodiments described above have provided examples in connection with mobile devices. However, the principles and advantages of the embodiments can be used for any other systems or apparatus that have needs for RF switching.

(145) Unless the context clearly requires otherwise, throughout the description and the claims, the words “comprise,” “comprising,” and the like are to be construed in an inclusive sense, as opposed to an exclusive or exhaustive sense; that is to say, in the sense of “including, but not limited to.” The word “coupled”, as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly connected, or connected by way of one or more intermediate elements. Likewise, the word “connected”, as generally used herein, refers to two or more elements that may be either directly connected, or connected by way of one or more intermediate elements. Additionally, the words

“herein,” “above,” “below,” and words of similar import, when used in this application, shall refer to this application as a whole and not to any particular portions of this application. Where the context permits, words in the above Detailed Description using the singular or plural number may also include the plural or singular number respectively. The word “or” in reference to a list of two or more items, that word covers all of the following interpretations of the word: any of the items in the list, all of the items in the list, and any combination of the items in the list.

(146) Moreover, conditional language used herein, such as, among others, “may,” “could,” “might,” “can,” “e.g.,” “for example,” “such as” and the like, unless specifically stated otherwise, or otherwise understood within the context as used, is generally intended to convey that certain embodiments include, while other embodiments do not include, certain features, elements and/or states. Thus, such conditional language is not generally intended to imply that features, elements and/or states are in any way required for one or more embodiments or that one or more embodiments necessarily include logic for deciding, with or without author input or prompting, whether these features, elements and/or states are included or are to be performed in any particular embodiment.

(147) The above detailed description of embodiments of the invention is not intended to be exhaustive or to limit the invention to the precise form disclosed above. While specific embodiments of, and examples for, the invention are described above for illustrative purposes, various equivalent modifications are possible within the scope of the invention, as those skilled in the relevant art will recognize. For example, while processes or blocks are presented in a given order, alternative embodiments may perform routines having steps, or employ systems having blocks, in a different order, and some processes or blocks may be deleted, moved, added, subdivided, combined, and/or modified. Each of these processes or blocks may be implemented in a variety of different ways. Also, while processes or blocks are at times shown as being performed in series, these processes or blocks may instead be performed in parallel, or may be performed at different times.

(148) The teachings of the invention provided herein can be applied to other systems, not necessarily the system described above. The elements and acts of the various embodiments described above can be combined to provide further embodiments.

(149) While certain embodiments of the inventions have been described, these embodiments have been presented by way of example only, and are not intended to limit the scope of the disclosure. Indeed, the novel methods and systems described herein may be embodied in a variety of other forms; furthermore, various omissions, substitutions and changes in the form of the methods and systems described herein may be made without departing from the spirit of the disclosure. The accompanying claims and their equivalents are intended to cover such forms or modifications as would fall within the scope and spirit of the disclosure.

Claims

1. A mobile device comprising: a power management system including a positive charge pump configured to generate a positive charge pump voltage, a negative charge pump configured to generate a negative charge pump voltage, and a voltage regulator configured to generate a regulated voltage; and a front end system including a radio frequency switch controlled by a first switch control signal, and a level shifter operable to level shift a first switch enable signal to generate the first switch control signal at a first output, the level shifter including a first enable level shifter powered by the positive charge pump voltage and configured to receive the first switch enable signal and to output a first level-shifted switch enable signal, a first level-shifting n-type transistor and a first cascode n-type transistor in series between the negative charge pump voltage and the first output, and a first level-shifting p-type transistor and a first cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the first output, the first level-shifting p-type

- transistor having a gate controlled by the first level-shifted switch enable signal, and the first cascode n-type transistor having a gate connected to the regulated voltage.
2. The mobile device of claim 1 wherein the level shifter further includes a second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor.
 3. The mobile device of claim 2 wherein the level shifter further includes a third cascode p-type transistor and a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.
 4. The mobile device of claim 2 wherein the level shifter further includes a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.
 5. The mobile device of claim 2 wherein a gate of the second cascode p-type transistor is controlled by a second switch enable signal.
 6. The mobile device of claim 5 wherein the level shifter further includes a second enable level shifter configured to receive the second switch enable signal and to output a second level-shifted switch enable signal, the second enable level shifter powered by the positive charge pump voltage.
 7. The mobile device of claim 1 wherein the front end system further includes a power amplifier configured to provide a radio frequency signal to the radio frequency switch.
 8. A level shifter for a radio frequency switch, the level shifter comprising: a first enable level shifter configured to receive a first switch enable signal and to output a first level-shifted switch enable signal, the first enable level shifter powered by a positive charge pump voltage; a first level-shifting n-type transistor; a first cascode n-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting n-type transistor between a negative charge pump voltage and a first output that provides a first switch control signal, a gate of the first cascode n-type transistor connected to a regulated voltage; a first level-shifting p-type transistor having a gate controlled by the first level-shifted switch enable signal; and a first cascode p-type transistor in series with the first level-shifting p-type transistor between the positive charge pump voltage and the first output.
 9. The level shifter of claim 8 further comprising a second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor.
 10. The level shifter of claim 9 further comprising a third cascode p-type transistor and a third level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.
 11. The level shifter of claim 9 further comprising a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.
 12. The level shifter of claim 9 wherein a gate of the second cascode p-type transistor is controlled by a second switch enable signal.
 13. The level shifter of claim 12 further comprising a second enable level shifter configured to receive the second switch enable signal and to output a second level-shifted switch enable signal, the second enable level shifter powered by the positive charge pump voltage.
 14. A radio frequency switch system comprising: a radio frequency switch configured to receive a radio frequency signal and controlled by a first switch control signal; a positive charge pump configured to generate a positive charge pump voltage; a negative charge pump configured to generate a negative charge pump voltage; a level shifter operable to level shift a first switch enable signal to generate the first switch control signal at a first output, the level shifter including a first enable level shifter powered by the positive charge pump voltage and configured to receive a first switch enable signal and to output a first level-shifted switch enable signal, a first level-shifting n-type transistor and a first cascode n-type transistor in series between the negative charge pump voltage and the first output, and a first level-shifting p-type transistor and a first cascode p-type transistor in series between the positive charge pump voltage and the first output, the first level-shifting p-type transistor having a gate controlled by the first level-shifted switch enable signal; and

a voltage regulator configured to generate a regulated voltage, a gate of the first cascode n-type transistor connected to the regulated voltage.

15. The radio frequency switch system of claim 14 wherein the level shifter further includes a second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and a gate of the first level-shifting n-type transistor.

16. The radio frequency switch system of claim 15 wherein the level shifter further includes a third cascode p-type transistor and a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the third cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.

17. The radio frequency switch system of claim 15 wherein the level shifter further includes a second level shifting n-type transistor in series with the second cascode p-type transistor between the regulated voltage and the negative charge pump voltage.

18. The radio frequency switch system of claim 15 wherein a gate of the second cascode p-type transistor is controlled by a second switch enable signal.
